What Michigan's new majority said after the election

Part 1 covers the main themes across lawmakers' election-night speeches and first interviews. Part 2 focuses on what they said about health care. Quotes are verbatim; the full 20-page report has every statement and transcript.

9	6	79	28
speeches and press events analyzed	leaders on camera	minutes of video transcribed	statements on health care

PART 1 **Post-election themes** Across all lawmakers reviewed

01

Key themes across lawmakers

What came up across speeches and interviews, with examples in their own words.

Lowering everyday costs

Benson · Brinks · Dingell · McMorrow

The most common theme. Leaders named groceries, rent, gas, housing, child care, energy and health care, and tied the election result to voters' frustration with prices.

- ▶ 4:30 **Jocelyn Benson:** *"lower our costs and raise our wages and end corruption"*
- ▶ 5:30 **Winnie Brinks:** *"together we will deliver on our commitment to make life more affordable for all"*
- ▶ 1:17 **Debbie Dingell:** *"the number one thing on everybody's mind working families is how much groceries were costing"*

Corruption, corporate power and money in politics

Benson · El-Sayed · Savit

Benson and Savit framed their wins as siding with people over "the powerful." El-Sayed called for getting money out of politics and taking on large corporations that raise prices.

- ▶ 4:54 **Jocelyn Benson:** *"fight the corruption that too often protects the … powerful and hurts the people."*
- ▶ 3:32 **Abdul El-Sayed:** *"I don't think that you should be left to a few big corporations to just consistently raise rates on you"*
- ¶ Michigan Advance **Eli Savit:** *"an attorney general who would represent the people and not the powerful"*

A mandate, and pressure to deliver

Puri · Dingell · Brinks · Camilleri · McMorrow

Leaders described the results as voters demanding change. Dingell warned that voters will send another message if Democrats don't deliver, and Brinks said progress comes from working across parties.

¶ Michigan Advance **Ranjeev Puri:** *“The people of Michigan spoke up tonight and said that they've had enough”*

▶ 1:50 **Debbie Dingell:** *“if we don't deliver in the next few years you're going to see them send another loud message”*

▶ 2:30 **Winnie Brinks:** *“Real progress doesn't come from one office or one party alone.”*

Pushing back on Trump and Washington

Benson · McMorrow · El-Sayed

Benson pledged to stand up to "any bully." McMorrow and El-Sayed criticized the president's record.

▶ 10:12 **Jocelyn Benson:** *“I will be unafraid to stand up to any bully, no matter how powerful”*

▶ 0:49 **Mallory McMorrow:** *“He's done none of those things.”*

▶ 10:27 **Abdul El-Sayed:** *“you've got a president who wants to defund the Department of Education. I think that's insane.”*

Specific plans they named

Benson · El-Sayed · Dingell

Few concrete plans were named. Benson named a state voting rights act; El-Sayed named the federal PRO Act for unions, stopping the Medicaid cuts, and Medicare for All. Dingell named reversing the Medicaid cuts (see Part 2).

▶ 6:43 **Jocelyn Benson:** *“pass a voting rights act for the state of Michigan”*

▶ 3:43 **Abdul El-Sayed:** *“I believe we need to pass the [PRO Act].”*

▶ 3:03 **Debbie Dingell:** *“one of the first things that we are going to do is to reverse the cuts in Medicaid”*

02

Summary of what was said on health care

From election night (Nov. 3) through Nov. 4, **6** Democratic leaders appeared on camera in **9** speeches, press events and interviews (**79** minutes of video). Three of them talked about health care: Abdul El-Sayed (21 statements), Debbie Dingell (5) and Jocelyn Benson (2). Winnie Brinks, Curtis Hertel Jr. and Mallory McMorrow did not mention health care.

El-Sayed said the first thing to do is stop the federal Medicaid cuts scheduled for January 2027. He said people who lose Medicaid will end up in emergency rooms, and that he expects some Republicans, especially from rural communities, to support reversing the cuts. He called for Medicare for All, said Blue Cross Blue Shield holds about 85% of Michigan's insurance market, and said insurers should not be able to raise rates by double digits or do stock buybacks.

Dingell said reversing the Medicaid cuts will be "one of the first things" the new U.S. House majority does, along with reinstating the ACA premium tax credit. She described constituents worried about losing Medicaid after receiving letters from the federal government. Benson listed health care with housing, child care and energy as costs her administration will make affordable, and pledged that women and girls will have access to the health care they need. Ranjeev Puri, quoted by the Michigan Advance, said he "watched healthcare be ripped away from our sick."

No leader mentioned hospitals, nurses or reimbursement, and no one named a specific state health bill. Attorney General-elect Eli Savit's victory remarks, as reported by the Michigan Advance and WLNS, did not mention health care.

03

What each leader said on health care

Health statements counted across each leader's appearances on video, Nov. 3–4.

LEADER	HEALTH STATEMENTS	WHAT THEY SAID
AS **Abdul El-Sayed** U.S. Senator-elect	21	Called stopping the January 2027 Medicaid cuts the first priority and Medicare for All the answer on health care. Criticized Blue Cross Blue Shield's market share and rate increases, and called for limits on rate increases and stock buybacks and for breaking up large corporations. Told stories of constituents struggling with insurance and medical costs.
DD **Debbie Dingell** U.S. Rep., MI-6	5	Said reversing the Medicaid cuts and reinstating the ACA premium tax credit will be among the new House majority's first acts. Described constituents afraid of losing Medicaid. Called the health care system "broken."
JB **Jocelyn Benson** Governor-elect	2	Listed health care with housing, child care and energy as costs to make affordable. Pledged that women and girls will have access to the health care they need. Named no specific health policy.
WB **Winnie Brinks** Lieutenant Governor-elect	–	Did not mention health care. Spoke about affordability and working across parties.
CJ **Curtis Hertel Jr.** Michigan Democratic Party Chair	–	Did not mention health care. Rallied supporters and predicted wins across the ticket.
MM **Mallory McMorrow** State Senator	–	Did not mention health care. Spoke about the economy, organizing and the U.S. Senate race.
RP **Ranjeev Puri** House Democratic Leader, likely Speaker	NEWS QUOTE	"I watched healthcare be ripped away from our sick" (election-night watch party, per the Michigan Advance). Named no specific health policy.
DC **Darrin Camilleri** State Senator	NEWS QUOTE	Did not mention health care. His statement was about the expanded Senate Democratic majority (per The Detroit News).
ES **Eli Savit** Attorney General-elect	NEWS QUOTE	Did not mention health care in his Nov. 4 victory remarks. Said he would represent "the people and not the powerful" and "I am going to work for you" (per the Michigan Advance and WLNS). No post-election video found.

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In their words: health care

Key health care lines, trimmed to the main point. Timestamps open the video at that moment.

▶ 2:25 **Abdul El-Sayed** (post-election interview, WDIV Local 4): *"the worst of this big ugly bill has not yet happened. They purposely pushed it into January of 2027, and that's the Medicaid cuts."*

▶ 2:39 **Abdul El-Sayed** (post-election interview, WDIV Local 4): *"instead of getting it in a primary care office before it's a lot worse and more expensive, they have to go to an emergency room."*

▶ 5:18 **Abdul El-Sayed** (post-election interview, WDIV Local 4): *"The attorney general right now is suing Blue Cross Blue Shield because they are basically 85% of our insurance market."*

▶ 8:06 **Abdul El-Sayed** (post-election interview, WDIV Local 4): *"when it comes to healthcare, look, the answer here is Medicare for all."*

▶ 3:03 **Debbie Dingell** (post-election interview, FOX 2 Detroit): *"one of the first things that we are going to do is to reverse the cuts in Medicaid"*

▶ 3:19 **Debbie Dingell** (post-election interview, FOX 2 Detroit): *"reinstate the affordable care tax credit until we can figure out what we really need to do to fix a broken health care system."*

▶ 8:00 **Jocelyn Benson** (transition press conference, Detroit): *"ensure from health care to housing to child care to our energy costs that those costs are affordable for everyone."*

▶ 6:21 **Jocelyn Benson** (victory speech, Hudson's Detroit): *"ensure that young girls and women always have access to the health care they need"*

¶ Michigan Advance **Ranjeev Puri** (Michigan Advance): *"I watched healthcare be ripped away from our sick."*

No post-election video found for: Eli Savit, Michigan Senate Democrats, Sean McCann, William Lawrence, Christina Hines, Jeremy Moss, Hillary Scholten, Kristen McDonald Rivet, Donavan McKinney, Rashida Tlaib, Gretchen Whitmer.

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